Two columns

The harbor town woke slowly. Fishing boats rocked against their moorings while gulls argued over the morning catch.

By nine the market stalls were open, and the smell of fresh bread drifted along the quay toward the old customs house.

Visitors who arrived early could watch the ferry load: crates of lemons, bicycles, a piano wrapped in blankets, and one very patient goat.

At noon the bell on the clock tower rang twelve times, although the clock itself had been running four minutes slow for as long as anyone remembered.

In the afternoon the wind turned, and the sails of the small regatta filled together like a flock of white birds.

Evening came with long shadows and the clatter of dishes. Lamps were lit along the pier, one after another, until the whole shore glowed.